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September 5, 2026

Schonfeld

Dear Schonfeld Hiring Team,

I am excited to apply for the Data Science Internship at Schonfeld. I am currently pursuing a master's degree in Data Science at Columbia University, building on a background in information systems, economics, analytics, and consulting. Schonfeld's focus on turning diverse financial data into curated datasets, research insights, and systematic signals is especially compelling to me because it brings together the work I most enjoy: building dependable data workflows, testing ideas quantitatively, and connecting technical analysis to consequential decisions.

Most recently, as a Research Assistant at Vietnam National University, I implemented and fine-tuned deep learning models in PyTorch and benchmarked their performance against established baselines. I also integrated a Geographical Random Forest model into an existing research pipeline and developed Python workflows for geospatial feature engineering, training, and evaluation. This experience strengthened my discipline around preprocessing, model validation, and reproducible research - the same foundations required to transform raw data into trustworthy features and analysis.

My prior roles taught me how to apply those foundations in fast-moving business settings. At Shopee, I engineered automated pipelines that consolidated sales and P&L data from multiple sources, reducing manual processing time by 20%, while my statistical analysis of seller performance, campaign effectiveness, and regional trends informed strategies that contributed to more than \$100,000 in revenue and 25% year-over-year growth. At BCG, I developed pricing, market-sizing, and financial models for executive decisions and collaborated with cross-functional teams on a \$10 billion infrastructure initiative. Across these experiences, I learned to scrutinize data quality, communicate findings clearly, and make analysis useful to stakeholders.

I have also developed end-to-end machine learning experience through a Kaggle housing-price project, where I built a reusable preprocessing pipeline, performed feature selection, trained scikit-learn and XGBoost models, and placed in the top 8% of more than 5,400 competitors. I would be excited to bring this combination of Python, SQL, statistical analysis, machine learning, and stakeholder collaboration to Schonfeld while deepening my understanding of financial asset classes, backtesting, and the research process behind alpha generation.

Schonfeld's collaborative model - with data scientists working alongside engineers and portfolio manager teams - is exactly the environment in which I hope to grow. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute careful research, reliable data workflows, and an interdisciplinary perspective to the team while learning from practitioners across the firm's Quant, Fundamental Equity, and Macro and Fixed Income strategies.

Sincerely,
Morgan Le